DEPARTMENT OF curriculum +instruction

Social Studies education

Timing

1. You can expect to take the written exam between September 1 – December 15 OR between May 1 – August 15
2. You will have 3.5 months to complete your written exam
3. Your committee members are asked to submit their decision and comments to your advisor within 2 weeks. You will be notified shortly thereafter
4. Contact your committee to schedule your oral exam immediately after you receive your written exam results. Plan to complete your oral exam the same same semester as your written exam.

Written Exam

The purpose of the paper is to provide evidence of your ability to investigate and report on a significant issue in social studies education. You are encouraged to focus on an issue that will serve as background material for your dissertation.

Exam type: scholarly paper of 30 - 50 pages, to be of publishable quality. Your paper may be conceptual or data-based; original data collection is optional. Include a critical analysis of prior scholarship on your topic.

You will be evaluated on:

- your ability to make a forceful, coherent, substantive academic argument employing the stylistic conventions of the field, including full references and a bibliography
- competence in terms of:
  - content knowledge
  - knowledge of research tools
  - devising research questions
  - referencing theory
  - marshalling evidence
  - and developing an argument

Your adviser will be available to read final drafts and will decide when the manuscript is ready for submission to committee members.

Possible Results: Pass, Revisions Required, Fail. Other committee members have two weeks to review your exam. If the committee members require revisions more than twice, you will be counseled out of the program.

Oral Exam

The purpose of the oral exam is to your assess knowledge of the field and your readiness for successful completion of your dissertation.

Your oral exam will focus on your written prelim, but may reference program coursework and general questions about the status of the field.

Because the written exam is related to the dissertation topic, you are typically asked questions about how you are conceptualizing your dissertation study.